

Reflection: PPG Digital IT Malaysia Technology Center Visit

The alignment between corporate operations and data architecture was clearly demonstrated during the technical visit to the PPG Digital IT Malaysia Technology Center. A comprehensive understanding was gained regarding PPG's end-to-end global process flow, tracking operations seamlessly from raw materials to final delivery. The session highlighted how enterprise systems like SAP Global Operations and Change Management tie directly into advanced data engineering practices, showing that real-world data pipelines must always serve a broader operational purpose.

Valuable technical insights were gathered from the architectural blueprint of PPG's Data Lake, which utilizes a modern cloud data stack. Data ingestion is orchestrated using Azure Data Factory, while the critical transformation layer is managed through Azure Databricks and Delta Lake. This live enterprise architecture serves as a perfect real-world representation of the Medallion Architecture, where data is structured into distinct Bronze, Silver, and Gold layers to ensure high data quality, governance, and exploration readiness.

The transition from student to industry professional was made significantly more relatable through firsthand sharing sessions delivered by interns currently placed at the center. Greater motivation has been fostered to approach upcoming academic projects, particularly those built around real enterprise case studies, with a rigorous production-grade mindset. Sincere appreciation is extended to the PPG Digital IT team for hosting the visit and for providing invaluable clarity on how data engineering principles are executed at a global scale.